

VISION SAUDI

2026 EDITION

Saudi Market Entry Guide

What international companies need to know before establishing in the Kingdom — from the first licence to full operations.

One Kingdom. One Vision. One Ecosystem.

A market opening at extraordinary speed

Saudi Arabia is transforming. Vision 2030 has opened the Kingdom to international investment, new industries and ambitious operators at a pace the region has never seen before.

But a Commercial Registration is only the beginning. A Saudi entity on paper cannot sponsor employee visas, sign commercial leases or invoice clients until every operational platform is activated. This guide walks through the full path.

Five stages from licence to growth

01

Establish

Enter with confidence.

MISA licensing, Commercial Registration, capital transfer and corporate bank account setup. Your Saudi entity starts here.

02

Activate

Turn registration into readiness.

Qiwa, GOSI, ZATCA and Balady — activating every platform your company needs to hire, sign contracts and begin operations.

03

Operate

Build the infrastructure behind the business.

Enterprise ERP, corporate communications, GRO management, payroll compliance and digital systems.

04

Connect

Business doesn't happen in isolation.

Office sourcing, legal advisory, banking relationships and connections to partner networks across the Kingdom.

05

Grow

Your Saudi story shouldn't end with setup.

Premium Residency pathways, joint ventures, regional expansion and long-term strategic positioning.

Choosing your entity

The right structure depends on ownership, activity and whether Saudi Arabia will be your regional base. Timelines below are indicative for a well-prepared applicant in professional services.

Limited Liability Company

100% foreign-owned Saudi company

5–9 weeks INDICATIVE

1. **MISA investment licence** — Foreign investment licence application and approval (1–2 wk)
2. **Commercial Registration** — Articles of Association and CR with the Ministry of Commerce (1–2 wk)
3. **Municipal & Chamber registration** — Balady licence and Chamber of Commerce membership (1 wk)
4. **Corporate bank account** — Account opening and capital deposit (2–3 wk)
5. **Government platform activation** — Qiwa, GOSI, ZATCA and Muqem — ready to hire and invoice (1–2 wk)

Branch of a Foreign Company

Extension of your existing parent company

6–11 weeks INDICATIVE

1. **Parent document legalisation** — Attestation of parent company documents via the Saudi embassy (2–4 wk)
2. **MISA investment licence** — Branch licence application and approval (1–2 wk)
3. **Commercial Registration** — Branch CR with the Ministry of Commerce (1–2 wk)
4. **Corporate bank account** — Account opening for the branch (2–3 wk)
5. **Government platform activation** — Qiwa, GOSI, ZATCA and Muqem — ready to hire and invoice (1–2 wk)

Regional Headquarters

Your MENA base under the RHQ programme

7–13 weeks INDICATIVE

1. **RHQ eligibility & licence** — Eligibility review and RHQ licence under MISA (2–4 wk)
2. **Commercial Registration** — RHQ CR with the Ministry of Commerce (1–2 wk)
3. **Office & premises** — Qualifying office space secured in Riyadh (2–4 wk)
4. **Corporate bank account** — Account opening and capital deposit (2–3 wk)
5. **Government platform activation** — Qiwa, GOSI, ZATCA and Muqem — ready to hire senior staff (1–2 wk)

Indicative only. Actual timelines depend on documentation quality and authority processing times. Trading and industrial activities add further licensing steps.

The platforms you must activate

After registration, these authorities and platforms determine whether you can actually hire, pay and invoice.

MISA	Foreign investment licensing
Ministry of Commerce	Commercial Registration
ZATCA	Tax, VAT & e-invoicing
Qiwa	Labour & workforce
GOSI	Social insurance
Muqem	Residency & visa services
Balady	Municipal licensing
Saudi Business Center	Business registration

Ready to plan your entry?

A senior strategist will map your exact timeline, government fees and document checklist.

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